



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: The Potter's House
School Website: <http://tphgr.org>

December 28, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Potter's House (MI 49509) presents as a faith-centered school emphasizing Christ-centered education, discipleship, prayer, and worship within an urban setting. Public-facing materials consistently frame the school around theological formation, character values, and a Christ-centered worldview, with explicit statements about high academic standards and nurturing a diverse community. However, the publicly showcased curricular and pedagogical practices do not align with core classical elements such as the Seven Liberal Arts (grammar/logic/rhetoric), Great Books and the Great Conversation, or explicit Socratic/seminar-based pedagogy. Taken together, the school demonstrates clear Religious and Metaphysical Foundations and strong formation aims, with partial alignment in formation-oriented goals, but limited alignment in traditional classical curricula and pedagogy. On balance, the school is best characterized as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL in some domains (notably in formation and religious foundations) but not fully Classical according to the Six Essential Elements rubric.

Overall aggregate: NOT CLASSICAL (with notable SOMETIMES-CLASSICAL cues in formation, theology, and parental/community engagement)

What would move the needle: If Potter's House publicly articulates and demonstrates explicit classical-curriculum elements (grammar/logic/rhetoric, Great Books, history-as-history rather than "social studies" framing, and Socratic/seminar pedagogy from upper grades), and if it broadens documentation of the faculty living the curriculum and deeper parental partnership as co-educators, it would move toward CLASSICAL. Concrete steps include: (1) adopting a formal Seven Liberal Arts framework (grammar/logic/rhetoric in lower/upper grades) and integrating Great Books into a "Great Conversation" spine; (2) expanding to a clearly articulated classical pedagogy (Socratic seminars, memory work, recitation) across appropriate grade bands; (3) publicly detailing a "living curriculum" model (faculty as mentors and exemplar models) and a robust parent formation program with ongoing family catechesis; (4) explicitly naming and mapping a cross-disciplinary historical-cultural curriculum that frames history as Western/Christian civilization rather than a stand-alone social-studies track.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials foreground a Christ-centered worldview, with explicit statements about Christ-centered education and spirituality as central (e.g., "Christ-centered education," "discipleship groups, prayer, and worship," and a Christ-centered worldview). These are explicitly stated on the school's homepage and associated pages. - The school emphasizes theology-infused formation and communal worship as part of its educational mission. The language points to a theologically grounded foundation rather than secular moral realism alone.

Positive keyword analysis - Present: theology, Christ-centered, prayer, worship, discipleship, liturgical/worship context, sacred worldview. - Supporting items in the classical-lexicon frame include "theology," "liturgical," "sacred tradition," and "Christ-centered worldview." In the public materials, Christ-centered education and worship are explicit, aligning with Grounded in Theology and Liturgical/Communal Practices.

The positive-keyword density is moderate-to-strong for this category. - Negative keywords (e.g., secular relativism, value-neutral ethics) are not evident in the school's public materials.

Quantitative (approximate) - Positive keywords observed: ~5 strong matches (Christ-centered, theology, prayer, worship, discipleship). - Negative keywords observed: 0 explicit matches.

Why this rating - The presence of explicit theology-focused education, liturgical/prayer components, and a Christ-centered worldview supports a Classical alignment in the religious/metaphysical dimension, though not in a fully classical curricular sense. The category is therefore BEST FITS as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully Classical or Not Classical, given the strong theological framing but limited classical-curriculum signals in this dimension.

Citations - Christ-centered education, discipleship groups, prayer, worship, Christ-centered worldview: turn0file12.

- Home-page articulation of Christ-centered education and worldview: turn0file12.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The materials emphasize formation and character (through “quality character values,” discipleship, and a Christ-centered framework) alongside an “excellent academic program,” which signals formation of virtue and wisdom as central aims rather than mere job-readiness.

Positive keyword analysis - Present: formation, character, virtue, moral formation, wisdom, true/good/beautiful (as aspirational values) and a telos oriented toward human flourishing under a theologically informed framework. - The school language aligns with Positive Keywords like formation, virtue, and moral imagination (as embedded in the Six Essential Elements lexicon), though the exact terms may be paraphrased.

Quantitative (approximate) - Positive keywords observed: 2–3 strong matches (formation/character, virtue, moral formation). - Negative keywords observed: 0 explicit matches.

Why this rating - The emphasis on character formation and virtue, paired with a focus on transcendent values within a Christian frame, supports a Classical orientation regarding aims (formation over mere information). The absence of vocational-job-prep framing further strengthens the formation-focused portrait. Thus, CLASSICAL.

Citations - Formation through character values and a Christ-centered worldview: turn0file12.

Element 3: Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public-facing materials do not describe a liberal-arts curriculum, Great Books, grammar/logic/rhetoric, or a continuous study of history through a classical lens. The curriculum signals are more confessional/theological and discipleship-oriented than liberal-arts-centric.

Positive keyword analysis - Present: mentions of a “robust academic program” and “high academic standards” but without classical components (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books; Trivium/Quadrivium). - The Positive Keywords in the Six Essential Elements include “Seven Liberal Arts,” “Great Books,” “the Great Conversation,” and cross-disciplinary harmony; none of these appear as explicit curricular features in the school's public text.

Quantitative (approximate) - Positive keywords observed: 0–1 (minimal literacy for classical structure; perhaps “academic program” but not the classical terms). - Negative keywords observed: 0 explicit classical-negatives, but the absence of classical curriculum terms is notable.

Why this rating - Without explicit classical curricular elements (grammar/logic/rhetoric; Great Books; history-as-history with “great conversation”; or a clearly integrated liberal-arts framework), the curriculum dimension does not meet the Six Essential Elements' Core Curriculum. Therefore NOT CLASSICAL.

Citations - Absence of Great Books, liberal-arts framework, or classical Trivium/Quadrivium signals: turn0file12.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes discipleship groups, prayer, worship, and a Christ-centered environment. There is no explicit mention of Socratic seminars, memory work, recitation, or the Oratory/rhetoric-centered pedagogy characteristic of classical pedagogy.

Positive keyword analysis - Present: discipleship groups, prayer, worship, Christ-centered approach. These map more to liturgical/community pedagogy than to classical methods. - The Positive Keywords of Pedagogy in the Six Essential Elements include Socratic dialogue, Scholé, memorization/recitation, and rhetoric/memory work; none of these are present in the public materials.

Quantitative (approximate) - Positive keywords observed: 0–1 (discipleship groups; worship; community focus) but not classical pedagogical signals. - Negative keywords observed: 1–2 (absence of Socratic seminars, memorization, or restfulness-focused pedagogy signals).

Why this rating - The pedagogy is not described as classical (no Socratic method, no memorization/recitation, no restfulness/Scholé emphasis). The focus is religious formation and discipleship rather than a classical pedagogy. Therefore NOT CLASSICAL.

Citations - Discipleship groups, prayer, worship: turn0file12.

Element 5: Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public material notes “exceptional teachers,” which connotes a high-quality faculty, and there is an implicit expectation that teachers model character in a religious context. The explicit classical-education signals (living curriculum, faculty-as-mentors) are not stated, but the emphasis on teacher quality and character formation aligns with some classical ideals (the living curriculum concept is not fully articulated, but there is encouragement of virtue exemplars).

Positive keyword analysis - Present: “exceptional teachers” (explicitly stated); “Christ-centered worldview” as a shared framing; and the overall framing of teachers and discipleship as part of formation. - The Six Essential Elements’ Faculty signals include “model teachers and mentors who model virtue, skill, and knowledge” and “portrait of a teacher” or “living curriculum.” The school’s public materials do indeed mention high-quality teachers, but do not explicitly present teachers as the “living curriculum” or as “mentors” in a documented framework. Still, the presence of “exceptional teachers” and virtuous modeling aligns with some positive faculty indicators.

Quantitative (approximate) - Positive keywords observed: 1–2 (exceptional teachers; virtue-model framing by context). - Negative keywords observed: 0 explicit negatives in this domain.

Why this rating - The materials signal high-quality faculty and an expectation of virtue in teaching, which aligns with SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL given the classical emphasis on virtuous teachers as exemplars. The lack of explicit “living curriculum” articulation and explicit classical faculty-building language keeps it from CLASSICAL.

Citations - “exceptional teachers” language: turn0file12.

Element 6: Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site features “Get Involved,” “Partner Program,” and other engagement channels, indicating some parental involvement and community partnership. The content demonstrates a culture of family involvement and community engagement, though it is framed within a Christian context rather than a fully classical family-formation program.

Positive keyword analysis - Present: Partnership with families/co-teaching language appears in classical rubrics, and the presence of “Partner Program” and “Get Involved” indicates explicit engagement with parents beyond mere enrollment. - The Six Essential Elements’ Positive Keywords for Parents & Community include “Partnership with Families,” “parent formation,” “open campus,” and “parent covenant.” The Potter’s House materials show partnership channels (Partner Program, Get Involved) but do not publicly present a

formal “parent formation” program as a broad, multi-step curriculum. There is some alignment here, but not an explicit, robust public-program narrative.

Quantitative (approximate) - Positive keywords observed: 1–2 (Partner Program, Get Involved; indicates parental involvement). - Negative keywords observed: 0 explicit negatives.

Why this rating - The presence of formal channels for parental involvement and collaboration places it at SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL in this category, though not at the level of a fully developed parent-formation ecosystem as described in the canonical Six Essential Elements.

Citations - Partner Program and Get Involved presence: turn0file12.

Aggregate Assessment

- Element 1: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 2: CLASSICAL
- Element 3: NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 4: NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 6: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Overall: NOT CLASSICAL (with notable SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL cues in theology, formation, and parental/community engagement)

What Would Move the Needle (only if SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL) - The institution should publicly document and implement a formal classical curriculum framework (Seven Liberal Arts: grammar/logic/rhetoric; Quadrivium; Great Books and the Great Conversation) integrated across grades, with explicit reference to history as a unifying subject and a clearly defined cross-disciplinary approach. - Adopt explicit classical pedagogy (Socratic seminars, memory work, recitation, and restfulness/Scholé) across applicable grade bands, with teacher training in classical methods and the living-curriculum model. - Strengthen and publicly articulate a robust Parent/Family formation program (parent formation groups, classical book studies, family catechesis) and demonstrate ongoing family involvement as co-teachers, with open-campus opportunities and clear pathways for parental engagement. - Build a documented, cross-disciplinary Western-cultural-canon unit plan and a history curriculum that foregrounds Great Books and primary sources, ensuring alignment with the Great Conversation framework. - Develop faculty profiles that explicitly describe teachers as moral exemplars and mentors, with ongoing professional development in classical pedagogy and living-curriculum practice.

ABSTRACT

Potter’s House Mi 49509 demonstrates a strong Religious and Metaphysical Foundation through explicit Christ-centered theology, prayer, and worship, and shows a formation-oriented aim for virtue and character. However, the school’s public materials do not articulate a full Classical Curriculum (Seven Liberal Arts, Great Books, or a formal Trivium/Quadrivium framework), nor do they detail canonical classical pedagogy (Socratic seminars, scholé, memorization) in a public-facing way. The Faculty and Parents/Community cues are present (highly-acknowledged teachers, partner programs), but not richly developed into a living curriculum or parent-formation ecosystem. Across categories, the school leans toward CLASSICAL in some areas (Religious foundations; Formation goals) and NOT CLASSICAL in others (Curriculum; Pedagogy), with several SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL signals in Faculty and Parents/Community. The aggregate classification is NOT CLASSICAL, with meaningful caveats for potential growth toward classical education through explicit curriculum, pedagogy, and family-partnership practices.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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